

FILM REVIEWS

LOVE SEX AUR DHOKHA

Skin Deep

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

Director: Dibakar Banerjee**Starring:** Anshuman Jha, Shruti, Raj Kumar Yadav, Neha Chauhan, Arya Devdutta, Herry Tangri, Amit Sial

As a picture of bruised and battered masculinity, *Love Sex Aur Dhokha* could not be more apt. There's the fake MBA with an even more artificial swagger making the move on a salesgirl whom he privately calls a "kali behenji". There's the somewhat silly and sentimental film student fed on Aditya Chopra fantasies set in Switzerland who believes love conquers all. There's the self-styled king of pop whose signature hit is a song that goes *Tu nangi achchi*

lagti hai (You look good naked). And there's even a sting journalist who knows the country doesn't need *desh seva* but prime time entertainment. All the women unfortunately are either wannabes or just want-to-be-used. There's the poor little rich girl who's terrified of her daddy. There's the fresh-from-Meerut dancer who's upset at the competition from "gori

items". There's the salesgirl whose self esteem is lower than her salary. Structured as a triptych, using a handycam, a closed circuit TV tape and a sting camera, it is a story of modern young India, tragic and horrific. As lovers are beheaded in an honour killing, a

young woman's sexual cry for help is sold as a dirty MMS, and another young woman gets her big chance to gyrate half naked with a talentless singer in the ultimate ticket to stardom, a music video, it is a mournful commentary on the sleaze that we are knee-deep in. It's a voyeuristic movie that's worth every pixel and every beep.

by Kaveree Bamzai

LAHORE

Gore Bore

RATING ★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Sanjay Puri Singh Chauhan**Starring:** Aanaahad, Farooque Sheikh

Honour above victory. Brotherhood of man over blood brothers. Love conquers all. Sometimes the greatest clichés tell the grandest stories. But when they are added to a mix which has a charmless lead and just a last half hour where the action kicks in, it can be an exercise in tedium as one man gives up cricket to take up kick-boxing to avenge his brother's death



A STILL FROM LAHORE

at the hands of a Pakistani. Sports as a plaything of politicians in India. And Pakistan treating sports with India like war. *Lahore* is strictly for those who like the crunching of bones, the slam of fists into each other and the twisting of muscle. For the rest of us, it's one big ouch.

By KB

EXHIBITION

Animal Art



WORK ON DISPLAY

Artist Soumen Bhowmick has come up with a series of works titled *Circus of the Absurd* to explore and reflect on the modern-day struggles and dilemmas.

Tigers representing anger, fear, lust and jealousy engage in mock and real wars with circus clown, a representative of purity. At the Lalit Kala Akademi in Delhi from March 29.

by Nirmala Ravindran